

Appendix F Survey Instructions

F.1 Recruitment + Baseline Survey

[Welcome] You are invited to participate in a research study. The purpose of the study is to understand college students' views on some political and socioeconomic issues.

To participate in the study, you will attend one Zoom session and complete three short surveys. The study will take a total of 60 minutes. As appreciation for your time, you will be compensated a total of \$20-\$24 for your participation, which will be distributed to you as an Amazon gift card after completing ALL parts of the study. During the study:

1. You will answer this survey, which should take about 7 minutes to complete. This survey will include questions about various political and socioeconomic issues. Your survey responses will be completely private and observable only to researchers.
2. You will take part in a Zoom session with other study participants that will last 45 minutes. During the Zoom session, you will discuss a set of political and socioeconomic issues with other study participants. The discussion sessions will take place between 3-5pm PT Monday - Friday. You need to attend ONE of the sessions, and you can choose the session that best fits your schedule. The slots will be posted on SONA, please check your email inbox for a notification when the slots are posted.
3. Immediately after the Zoom session, you will answer a brief survey, which should take about 5 minutes to complete. Again your survey responses will be private and observable only to researchers.

Participation in this study is completely voluntary. You have the right to decline to participate or to withdraw at any point in this study. To learn more details about the study, please review the following consent document: [\[link to the consent file\]](#)

[Private Beliefs] In the first part of this survey, you will read statements on 10 political and socioeconomic issues. After reading each statement, you will be asked whether you agree or disagree with the statement. Please note that you can skip any question that you do not want to answer. Your survey responses will be kept private.

[Perceived Belief Distribution] In the second part of this survey, you will again read statements on the same 10 political and socioeconomic issues. After reading each statement, you will be asked to provide your guesses about what percentage of other study participants agree or disagree with the statement, as well as how certain you are about your guesses. Note that all study participants are current students at UC Berkeley.

At the end of the study, we will randomly select one of your guesses. For this statement, you will have a chance to receive a bonus of \$4 and you will maximize your chance of earning the bonus if you report your beliefs as accurately as possible. That is, there is nothing to gain by stating a number that differs from what you actually belief. You can find details about the bonus payment here [link to the Binary Scoring Rule].

(For each statement, participants get the following question): Among all Berkeley students who participate in this study, what percentage do you think will privately answer “agree” and “disagree” with this statement respectively? (please enter integers) Agree ___%; Disagree ___%

(Following their guesses, participants are also asked) How certain do you feel about your guesses above? (Choose between Certain and Uncertain)

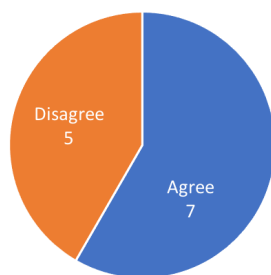
F.2 Midline Survey

The midline survey is sent 12 hours before participants’ scheduled Zoom sessions.

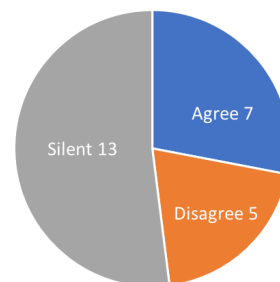
[Welcome] Thank you for completing the first part of our study. To help you get a better sense about the Zoom discussion, below we will show you summaries about earlier Zoom sessions conducted with other study participants who are also Berkeley students.

Then we present summary statistics on 4 topics that were discussed in Zoom sessions. We use one of the topics as an example here:

25 randomly selected Berkeley students like you discussed over Zoom if they agreed with the following statement: “If Proposition 209 was repealed, universities in the UC system should adopt extensive affirmative action policies that explicitly take into account race in the admission process.” Here is a summary of their Zoom discussion:



Shown to the Control group



Shown to the Treatment group

- Among all Berkeley students who participate in this study, what percentage do you think will privately answer “agree” and “disagree”? (please enter integers)

Agree ___%; Disagree ___%

- How certain do you feel about your guesses above? (Certain or Uncertain)

F.3 Endline Survey

The endline survey is distributed at the end of the Zoom session.

[Perceived belief distribution] *For each of the 4 topics, we again ask participants to provide their guesses about what percentage of other study participants agree or disagree with the statement.*

- Among all Berkeley students who participate in this study, what percentage do you think will privately answer “agree” and “disagree” with the following statement? (please enter integers) Agree ___%; Disagree ___%
- How certain do you feel about your guesses above? (Certain or Uncertain)

[Expressions on a different topic] In an earlier survey, we asked if you agreed or disagreed with the following statement. “Transgender athletes should not be allowed to compete in female sports at the college level.”

We want to let Berkeley students know what other students think about this topic. This is your opportunity to tell other students what you think. If you would like to share your opinion with the other Berkeley students participating in this study, please indicate whether you agree or disagree with this statement and why. Your responses will be shared publicly with other study participants. You can also skip this question if you do not want to answer it or if you do not want to share your answers with other study participants.

[Recall] Now please take a moment to recollect the Zoom session that you just attended and answer the following question.

- How many students (excluding study moderators) were in the Zoom session?
- (For each statement) In the Zoom session, how many students agreed, disagreed or stayed silent when discussing the following statement? (please enter integers)
- (For each statement) Among those who stayed silent on this topic during the Zoom discussion, how many do you think privately “agree” and “disagree” respectively? (please enter integers)

F.4 Binary Scoring Rule

Determining your bonus: Your bonus will be determined by randomly selecting one of the statements to count and computing your payment according to the procedure below for the statement that counts.

1. You will state your guesses about the percentage of Berkeley students who privately agree/disagree with the statement. Denote your guess G (between 0 – 100) as the percentage of Berkeley students who privately answer “Agree”.
2. The computer will randomly draw two numbers, X and Y , each with values between 0 and 100. For each draw, each number is equally likely to be selected. Draws are independent in the sense that the value selected for X in no way affects the value selected for Y and vice versa.
3. The computer will then randomly select one Berkeley student who participated in this study and get her anonymized answer (the answer will be kept private).
4. If the students’ answer is “Agree”, then you receive the bonus if your guess G is greater than or equal to either X or Y .
5. If the students’ answer is “Disagree”, then you receive the bonus if your guess G is smaller than either X or Y .

The procedure is designed so that you have the best chance of winning the bonus when you state your beliefs as accurately as possible about the fraction of Berkeley students you think privately agree or disagree with the statement.

F.5 Social Appropriateness of Statements

Following [Krupka and Weber \(2013\)](#), we elicit the social appropriateness of agreeing with each of the topic.

In this part of the survey, you will read statements on 10 political and socioeconomic issues. After reading each statement, you will be asked to evaluate whether the statement is “socially appropriate” and “consistent with moral or proper social behavior” or “socially inappropriate” and “inconsistent with moral or proper social behavior” at UC Berkeley. By socially appropriate, we mean behavior that most students at UC Berkeley agree is the “correct” or “ethical” thing.

At the end of the survey, we will randomly select one of the statements. For this statement, we will determine which response was selected by the most Berkeley students who answered

this survey. If you give the same response as that most frequently given by other students, you will receive an additional \$2. For instance, if we randomly select the first statement and if your response had been “somewhat socially appropriate,” then you would receive \$2 if this was the response selected by most other students who answered this survey.

[For each statement, we ask:] Please indicate whether you believe holding this opinion is socially appropriate. (Choose between very socially inappropriate, somewhat socially inappropriate, neither socially appropriate nor inappropriate, somewhat socially appropriate, very socially appropriate.)

Appendix G Zoom sessions script

[Moderators: Have the following documents ready: 1) Slides; and 2) the random number sheet. Begin recording the Zoom session to the cloud as soon as the session begins.]

[Introduction] Thank you all for joining us today. This Zoom session is the second part of your participation in the study and should take approximately 50 minutes. My name is [moderator’s name] and I will be moderating today’s Zoom session. While we are waiting for the session to begin, please take 2 minutes to complete the brief survey we emailed you yesterday if you have not already done so.

To encourage active participation, we request that you keep your camera on throughout the Zoom session and your microphone muted unless you are called upon to speak. Also, if you haven’t already done so, please take a minute to change your Zoom display name to your first name plus the first initial of your last name. Note that we will be recording this Zoom session for research purposes. Please keep everything that is discussed in this Zoom session private.

Before we get started, let’s do a quick round of introductions. When I call your name, please unmute yourself and briefly tell us your year and major at Berkeley. And please let me know if I am pronouncing your name correctly. *[Conduct introductions, calling on participants in the order they appear on the moderator’s screen. After each person you can say “thank you” or “welcome”]* Did I miss anyone?

Welcome everyone. To give you a quick overview of how we will structure our Zoom discussion, we have selected a few current socio-economic issues for us to discuss as a group. For each topic, I will first give you a brief introduction of the topic, then everyone who is interested will have a chance to express their views. Specifically, after introducing the topic I will read you a statement and you will have 90 seconds to decide if you’d like to share your views on the topic with everyone else in this Zoom room. If you would like to share your views, simply send a private chat message to me, the moderator, indicating whether you

“agree” or “disagree” with the statement. If you do not wish to share your views simply do not send a message to the moderator. I will then call on everyone who replied to one-by-one briefly state why they agree or disagree with the statement. Everyone who responds in the chat will be called upon, and I will randomly choose the order in which people are called upon. Please try to keep your comments respectful and under 1 minute. Please note that your study compensation will NOT depend on whether or not you share your views, or which views you share in the discussion. Your compensation just depends on whether you complete all parts of the study. Do you have any questions or comments before we begin?

[Topic 1: Daylight Saving Time] On March 2nd, a bill to make daylight saving time permanent in the U.S. was reintroduced in the Senate. The new Sunshine Protection Act is similar to the bill introduced last year. If passed, the clocks would not change again in November, or ever again. *[Moderator: Put in the chat: “Topic 1”]*

Now, we would like to hear your thoughts on daylight saving time. Do you agree or disagree with the following statement: “Daylight saving time should be eliminated”. Please send the moderator a direct chat message saying “Agree” or “Disagree” if you would like to express your opinions. *(Discussion: Using the random order spreadsheet, call on everyone who responded via chat in a random order. You can respond “thanks for sharing” or “thank you” after each person. You can also say “30 seconds left” or “10 seconds left” if someone is going over time)* *[Conclusion for this topic]* Thank you everyone for sharing your views on this topic. Now I’ll introduce the next topic.

[Topic 2: Renaming Schools] Since 2020, 82 schools across the country have been renamed because they honored controversial historical figures. In the Bay area, the San Francisco Unified School District voted on renaming 44 schools named after controversial public figures. *[Moderator: Put in the chat: “Topic 2”]*

Now we would like to hear your thoughts on this topic. Do you agree or disagree with the following statement: “All public schools named after controversial historical figures, including former Presidents George Washington, Thomas Jefferson, and Abraham Lincoln, should be renamed.” Again, please send the moderator a direct chat message saying “Agree” or “Disagree” if you would like to express your opinions. *(Discussion: Using the random order spreadsheet, call on everyone who responded via chat in a random order. You can respond “thanks for sharing” or “thank you” after each person. You can also say “30 seconds left” or “10 seconds left” if someone is going over time)* *[Conclusion for this topic]* Thank you everyone for sharing your views on this topic. Now I’ll introduce the next topic.

[Topic 3: Death penalty] The debate over the death penalty in the United States existed as early as the colonial period. Gallup has monitored support for the death penalty in the United States since 1937 in their surveys and observed gradual changes in respondents’

beliefs. We would like to understand what current college students think about the death penalty. *[Moderator: Put in the chat: "Topic 3"]*

Do you agree or disagree with the following statement: "The U.S. should abolish the death penalty." Again, please send the moderator a direct chat message saying "Agree" or "Disagree" if you would like to express your opinions. (Discussion: Using the random order spreadsheet, call on everyone who responded via chat in a random order. You can respond "thanks for sharing" or "thank you" after each person. You can also say "30 seconds left" or "10 seconds left" if someone is going over time) [Conclusion for this topic] Thank you everyone for sharing your views, now let's move on to the next topic.

[Topic 4: Affirmative Action] The Supreme Court is revisiting the use of ethnicity in college admissions policies, marking the third time in the last decade. The cases spotlight perennial questions about how highly competitive universities select incoming classes from a flood of applications and how they treat applicants of different racial backgrounds when reviewing their files. *[Moderator: Put in the chat: "Topic 4"]*

Do you agree or disagree with the following statement: "If Proposition 209 was repealed, universities in the UC system should adopt extensive affirmative action policies that explicitly take into account race in the admission process." Again, please send the moderator a direct chat message saying "Agree" or "Disagree" if you would like to express your opinions. (Discussion: Using the random order spreadsheet, call on everyone who responded via chat in a random order. You can respond "thanks for sharing" or "thank you" after each person. You can also say "30 seconds left" or "10 seconds left" if someone is going over time) [Conclusion for this topic] Thank you everyone for sharing your views, this was our final topic for today's session.

[Moderator: ONLY show the slides and use the script below if the previous discussion has been less than 35 minutes. Put in the chat: "Topic 5"]

[Topic 5: Immunizations] As schools enter the sixth semester of the pandemic, prevention measures such as vaccine mandates have become increasingly diverse and inconsistent. Schools across the country have adopted a wide range of vaccine policies based on CDC and public health guidance, state laws, religious beliefs and other factors.

Now, we would like to hear your thoughts on immunizations on Berkeley's campus. Do you agree or disagree with the following statement: "Immunizations, such as for Covid and the flu, should be required on Berkeley's campus." Again, please send the moderator a direct chat message saying "Agree" or "Disagree" if you would like to express your opinions. (Discussion: Using the random order spreadsheet, call on everyone who responded via chat in a random order. You can respond "thanks for sharing" or "thank you" after each person. You can also say "30 seconds left" or "10 seconds left" if someone is going over time) [Conclusion for this

topic] Thank you everyone for sharing your views, this was our final topic for today's session.

[Conclusion] That concludes our discussion today. Thank you all for participating, for being willing to share your views and listen to the views of others. To complete your participation in this study, please answer a final short survey. I just posted the link to the survey in the chat and it should take no more than 5 minutes to complete. You do have to complete this survey to meet all the requirements of this study and receive compensation. Feel free to turn off your video while you answer the survey or you may leave the Zoom room entirely if you prefer, please just complete it within the next 10 minutes. In the meantime, please let us know if you have any questions and thanks again for your participation today.

[Moderator: Keep the Zoom room open until the end of the scheduled slot or until the last participant has left. Before closing the Zoom room, please export the chat]